

Semantic Content Analysis — Pair 0063

Metadata

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Turn Pair

Question (MS. EASTERLING):

And your opinions in that case were -- were they blaming the plaintiff for the incident? (MR. GRINNAN objection: object to the form, foundation.)

Answer (BENJAMIN GIBSON):

I don't think it was necessarily blaming the plaintiff in that case. I think it was noting that Energy Transfer was not involved in that work. They hired that contractor. They -- this guy was the foreman and had chose the means and method, that was more the theme in that case for -- given the nuances of that specific matter.

Pattern Declaration

Blame Deflection

The question probes whether the expert blamed the plaintiff, but the answer redirects focus to Energy Transfer and contractor details, shifting the blame discussion away from the plaintiff. Across the lenses, the topic remains the same case, yet the semantic anchor and intensity reveal a deliberate deflection of blame. Thus the two-word pattern captures the shift from blame inquiry to contextual explanation.

Analysis

Call 1 · Semantic Presence

Topic Presence

The exchange centers on the expert's prior opinions concerning blame in a specific case, touching on the roles of Energy Transfer, a hired contractor, and the foreman's choice of means and method.

Reasoning: Both turns refer to the same case and discuss whether the expert's opinions blamed the plaintiff, mentioning Energy Transfer and contractor details.

- And your opinions in that case were
- I don't think it was necessarily blaming the plaintiff in that case.

Topic Specificity

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Reasoning: The discussion focuses on particular entities (Energy Transfer, contractor, foreman) and specific aspects of the case, indicating a high degree of narrowing.

- Energy Transfer was not involved in that work
- this guy was the foreman

Topic Stability

state: stable

result: topic unchanged

mechanism: consistent focus

Reasoning: Both the question and the answer refer to the same case and the same issue of blame, showing no shift in subject.

- in that case

Call 2 · Semantic Anchor

Referential Target

state: same

if_same: that case

Reasoning: Both the question and the answer refer to the same incident or case, using the phrase "that case" and discussing whether the plaintiff was blamed.

- And your opinions in that case were -- were they blaming the plaintiff for the incident?
- I don't think it was necessarily blaming the plaintiff in that case.

Actor Presence

actor_present: true

identity: Energy Transfer

type: institution

role: subject

action: not involved

Reasoning: The answer explicitly mentions Energy Transfer as not involved in the work, indicating an identifiable institution being discussed.

- Energy Transfer was not involved

Object Focus

that case

Reasoning: The central topic of both turns is the case or incident being discussed, as indicated by repeated references to "that case".

- And your opinions in that case were -- were they blaming the plaintiff for the incident?
- I don't think it was necessarily blaming the plaintiff in that case.

Call 3 · Semantic Class

Domain Type

class_name: Legal · *domains:* Litigation | Expert testimony | Contractor | Method | Blame

Reasoning: The exchange centers on a deposition question about expert opinions in a litigation context, referencing contractor involvement and methods, indicating a legal domain with subdomains of litigation, expert testimony, contractor relations, procedural method, and blame attribution.

- And your opinions in that case were -- were they blaming the plaintiff for the incident?
- I think it was noting that Energy Transfer was not involved in that work. They hired that contractor.

Emotional Presence

present: no

source: —

emotion_array: (none)

Reasoning: Neither turn contains explicit emotional language or affective markers; the content is purely factual and procedural.

Intensity Scale

turn_1_to_turn_2: score: 4

turn_2_to_turn_1: score: 4

Reasoning: The question carries a mild accusatory tone, and the answer provides a calm, explanatory response; overall the semantic intensity is low■moderate in both directions.

- And your opinions in that case were -- were they blaming the plaintiff for the incident?
- I don't think it was necessarily blaming the plaintiff in that case.

Call 4 · Semantic Function

Semantic Intent

intents: intent_name: probe blame stance · importance: large | intent_name: challenge foundation · importance: medium | intent_name: test witness credibility · importance: small

Reasoning: The question seeks to determine whether the witness's opinions blamed the plaintiff, thereby probing the witness's stance. It also challenges the foundation of the witness's testimony, and indirectly tests the witness's credibility.

- "And your opinions in that case were -- were they blaming the plaintiff for the incident?"

Direction Of Force

origin: Ms. Easterling's question

name: probe blame

magnitude_and_direction: 3

target: Benjamin Gibson

description: The question pushes Gibson to clarify whether his opinions blamed the plaintiff, potentially leading to a negative implication.

Reasoning: The question is directed at Gibson to elicit a specific admission or denial of blame, exerting a strong positive push toward that clarification.

- "And your opinions in that case were -- were they blaming the plaintiff for the incident?"

Resolution State

state: narrow

Reasoning: Gibson's answer moves away from blaming the plaintiff and focuses on contractor involvement, narrowing the discussion from blame to underlying causes.

- "I don't think it was necessarily blaming the plaintiff in that case."
- "They hired that contractor."

Call 5 · Semantic Complexity

Concept Density

state: layered

if_layered: blaming plaintiff | Energy Transfer involvement | foreman methods | means and method

Reasoning: The exchange contains several distinct concepts: the question centers on whether the opinions blamed the plaintiff, while the answer expands to discuss Energy Transfer's non■involvement, the contractor, the foreman's role, and the means and method used. These concepts are layered rather than competing or singular.

- And your opinions in that case were -- were they blaming the plaintiff for the incident?

- I don't think it was necessarily blaming the plaintiff in that case.

Semantic Drift

state: shifting

from: blaming plaintiff

to: Energy Transfer

Reasoning: The question focuses on blaming the plaintiff, but the answer redirects the discussion toward Energy Transfer's lack of involvement and other contextual details, indicating a shift in semantic focus.

- And your opinions in that case were -- were they blaming the plaintiff for the incident?
- I think it was noting that Energy Transfer was not involved in that work.

Concept Coupling

state: loosely_adjacent

side_a: blaming plaintiff

side_b: Energy Transfer involvement | foreman methods | means and method

Reasoning: The concepts introduced in the answer are related to the question's focus but are not tightly linked; they are mentioned in a broader context, making the coupling loosely adjacent.

- And your opinions in that case were -- were they blaming the plaintiff for the incident?
- I think it was noting that Energy Transfer was not involved in that work.